

Session 5 — Shewa: Vocal vs. Silent

BBH 2026.1 · Ch3 Review · 10 items

For each word, a target letter bearing a shewa is identified. Determine whether the shewa is Vocal or Silent and state the rule. Vocal shewa: (1) word-initial, (2) after another shewa, (3) under dagesh forte. Silent shewa: (1) word-final, (2) all other positions.

Exercise — 10 items

#	Word	Target	Vocal or Silent?	Rule
1	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בְּ ()		
2	מֶלֶךְ	ךְ ()		
3	יְרוּשָׁלַיִם	יְ ()		
4	מִשְׁפָּט	שְׁ ()		
5	בְּרִית	בְּ ()		
6	יִשְׂרָאֵל	שְׁ ()		
7	כְּבוֹד	כְּ ()		
8	נִשְׁמַר	שְׁ ()		
9	שְׁמַע	שְׁ ()		
10	יִשְׁלַח	שְׁ ()		

Answer Key

#	Word	Target	Type	Rule
1	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בְּ		
✓	בְּרֵאשִׁית	בְּ	Vocal	Word-initial: every word begins with a vowel sound
2	מֶלֶךְ	ךְ		
✓	מֶלֶךְ	ךְ	Silent	Word-final: marks close of the last syllable; no sound
3	יְרוּשָׁלַיִם	יְ		
✓	יְרוּשָׁלַיִם	יְ	Vocal	Word-initial: Yod begins the word
4	מִשְׁפָּט	שְׁ		
✓	מִשְׁפָּט	שְׁ	Silent	Middle-of-word, not initial, no dagesh forte → closes syllable מִשְׁ
5	בְּרִית	בְּ		
✓	בְּרִית	בְּ	Vocal	Word-initial: Bet begins the word
6	יִשְׂרָאֵל	שְׁ		
✓	יִשְׂרָאֵל	שְׁ	Silent	Middle-of-word after short Hireq (יִ.) → closes syllable יִשְׁ
7	כָּבוֹד	כְּ		
✓	כָּבוֹד	כְּ	Vocal	Word-initial: Kaf begins the word
8	נִשְׁמֵר	שְׁ		
✓	נִשְׁמֵר	שְׁ	Silent	Middle-of-word after short Hireq (נִ.) → closes syllable נִשְׁ
9	שָׁמַע	שְׁ		
✓	שָׁמַע	שְׁ	Vocal	Word-initial: Shin begins the word
10	יִשְׁלַח	שְׁ		
✓	יִשְׁלַח	שְׁ	Silent	Middle-of-word after short Hireq (יִ.) → closes syllable יִשְׁ